TEAM REPORT

TITLE	Consultant's corner Acquisition Report
TEAM NAME	Consultant's corner
TEAM NUMBER	CC07_Team 5
CATEGORY OF ENTERPRISE SYSTEM SOFTWARE SPECIALISATION	HRM - Human Resource Management System
NAME OF YOUR TARGET CONSULTING COMPANY	EY - Ernst & Young
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DOCUMENT VERSION	v.9.1
EFFECTIVE DATE	25th October 2024
WORD COUNT	*7774 words*

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1. Introduction

1.1. What is an enterprise system software?

Enterprise system software, also known as enterprise application software (EAS) is a large-scale software that is operated in a corporate environment. These systems help to manage strategic business processes like financials, logistics, sales and marketing management, customer relationship management, and human resource management, by interconnecting different functions of an organisation (Wognum et al., 2004). The main purpose of enterprise system software is to enhance organizational productivity, data credibility, and decision-making capabilities through the availability of real-time data and integration of business processes across functional areas.

Enterprise systems differ from other types of system software, like operating systems and utilities in terms of their capabilities and the extent of their application. As opposed to system software, which includes Windows, Linux, or macOS that is responsible for managing resources of the hardware and providing the elementary functionalities for computers, enterprise system software works on a different level, which is on the level of business processes optimization and automation rather than working with the hardware (Shahzad, 2023). However, the system software is for personal use or uniquely identifiable devices while enterprise system software is for an entire business encompassing many users or departments and, at times, third-party entities.

1.2. What is the purpose of this report?

The purpose of this report is to design a comprehensive overview of our own tasked IT consultancy company (Consultant's corner) and the process that our company takes in the enterprise system software of Human Resources Mangement in the support of our client's needs. The report ultimately has the goal of being used to demonstrate and convince the multinational consultancy firm EY (Ernst & Young) in acquiring and integrating our firm into the organisation (Shah, 2023).

There are few aspects that we must focus on in this report:

1. Client's requirements: we must understand and meet with the clients to completely understand the reasons for which they want to integrate or improve upon the Human resource management systems. Drafting a plan for how the needs can match with current industry standards in this enterprise system software for the clients (Wang & Chen, 2006).

2. Integration: Facilitating the integration of the drafted plan for improving the Human Resources Management systems of the client. The strategy our consulting firm will use will implement measures to ensure cost saving and efficient business planning

3. Strategic development goals: Aiding the organisation to reach the long-term target by designing a strategic plan to be utilised in both the short and long term after the implementation of the Human Resource Management system. This will be drafted to be in line with what the original objective and

long-term plans outlined during the initial stage (Olugbode, Richards & Biss, 2007).

2. Consultant's corner's enterprise system software specialisation

2.1. Category of enterprise system software

Human resource management (HRM) is an important role of enterprise software, this software would help companies to better control their human resources processes.

HRM includes employee data management, payroll processing, benefits administration, recruitment, training and performance management (Kavanagh etc, 2015). These systems would control the HR data and streamline processes centralised and make the HR department more efficient. HR system also cooperates with other enterprise systems such as payroll and finance systems to ensure the data would pass through the whole organisation (Stone & Deadrick, 2015). After HR tasks are transferred to automation, the HRM systems would concentrate on the approach of employee engagement and talent retention. For example, SAP SuccessFactors, a HRM system based on the cloud technology, which manages the whole employee's lifecycle, from joining the organizasion until retirement, and offer the educated resource to encourage the worker learning continuously and performance management (Gueutal& Stone, 2005).

2.2. Typical characteristics of Human Resources Management enterprise system software

CHARACTERISTICS		INFORMATION COLLATED FROM RELIABLE SOURCES
	OBJECTIVE	**VALUE CREATED**
List of objectives[1] of Human Resources Management enterprise system software in terms of creating value[2] for a client organisation and its stakeholders[3]	**Improving Recruitment and onboarding process:** Automate posting jobs across multiple platforms, then tracking the applicants, and managing the recruitment process.	**Value to the organisation:** Organisation can find the suitable employees easier and more efficient. In addition, choosing individuals best suited to contribute to organizational goals. (Way & Johnson, 2005) A structural onboarding process helps that new employees understand their jobs and how they fit into the organisation's goals.
		Value to Managers: Recruitment and selection are key components

[1] **Objective -** A thing aimed at or sought; a goal - the achievement of which can be measured

[2] **Value -** Monetary (profit) can be created for an organisation by e.g., growth in customer base, reduced costs, new services, enhanced service. For stakeholders value created could be e.g., access to all data in one place saves time for customers

[3] **Stakeholders -** A person with an interest in the organisation

	For instance, using social media and digital platforms to reach suitable candidates (Kara et al., 2024). Guiding new employees through the onboarding process, including paperwork completion, training, and orientation.	of HRM systems. The purpose is to provide a large pool of well-suited job applicants and to maximize the quality of individuals hired (Stone et al., 2013). HRM systems reduce the workload of posting on different platforms. Managers only needs to interview peoples. The standard onboarding process let manager to use less resources to train new employees.
		Value to Employees: Employees can follow the established onboarding process let the new employees stay on the right track quickly. Individuals' values influence HRM system processes such as recruitment, selection, training, performance management, and compensation (Stone, Stone-Romero & Lukaszewski, 2007).
	Promoting the Payroll and employee benefits: HRM ensures the right staff focusing on staffing, payroll, and benefits. It also ensures fair pay, coworker support, and enough benefits for employee engagement (Cleveland, Byrne & Cavanagh, 2015). Automatically calculate salaries, including deductions for taxes, extra benefits, and stocks…etc. And also providing some benefits for employees, including health insurance and retirement plans.	**Value to the organisation:** Automation of calculating salaries can significantly reduce the time spent on repetitive tasks, minimise errors, and ensure accuracy. Improving working conditions, providing training, and ensuring ethical practices can enhance employee well-being and attract more talented employees, leading to higher productivity and performance (Jiang et al., 2024).
		Value to Owner: Timely and accurate payroll contributes to employee satisfaction. Employees can motivate by providing non-monetary welfare benefits, leading to higher productivity and performance (Sun, Habib & Bhuiyan, 2020). In addition, it shows that employees are value their work, which can enhance morale and productivity. Helping owner gain more reliable from employees.
		Value to HR team: Payroll data can provide valuable insights of the workforce. This can help HR team make decisions about benefits and workforce planning. Tactical workforce management can increase employee's value. Outsourcing HR services can lead to improved performance and cost savings, adding more value to the HR team (Butler & Callahan, 2014).
	Boosting productivity and performance: HRM system improves organisational effectiveness through individual	**Value to the organisation:** HRM system practices influence organizational performance by improving efficiency, increasing business revenue, and affecting labour productivity (Cho et al., 2006). For instance, HRM system provides continuous

	performance, including motivation, and reward system (Karatop, Kubat & Uygun, 2015). Employees who are given an opportunity to learn, improve performance, and work towards organisation goals.	feedback by enabling managers and employees to deliver comments and updates in real-time. In this way, goal-tracking features push employees to track their progress, making higher engagement and productivity.
		Value to Investors: HRM system must decrease labour costs or increase revenue to exceed above-average financial returns (Banks & Kepes, 2015). For instance, higher productivity often leads to reduced costs and increased output, which can improve profits. Investors see this as a good sign of a healthy, efficient company to invest.
		Value to Clients: Increased efficiency in operations allows organisations to deliver products or services faster, which are clients willing to see. For instance, strategic HRM system can improve performance in customer service, product quality and customer satisfaction (Ren & Jackson, 2020).
Brief description of the components[4] of Human Resources Management enterprise system software, the features[5] within each of those components, and what those features do.	**COMPONENT**	**FEATURES of COMPONENT**
	Data warehouse: This the process in which HR data is gathered and analysed to help make decisions and develop strategies to help improve the organisations effectiveness in human resource management (Madid, 2023).	**Feature 1: <u>HR analytics</u>** HR analytics refers to the use of analytical processes on human resource functions. It is the "quantification of people drivers on business outcomes" (Muktamar, 2024).
		Feature 2: <u>Benchmarking</u> This feature involves uses both industrial and historical data to determine if certain metrics such as performance is meeting the correct standards relative to peers in the industry and within the organisation (Bogetoft, 2015). The ultimately will be used to identify areas for improvement.
	Employee development program: This is a platform either externally or internally made that can deliver and manage training programs online, while	**Feature 1: <u>Learning management system (LMS)</u>** This is a platform either externally or internally made that can deliver and manage training programs online, while at the same time being able to track progress and record results (Ilyas, Kadir, & Adnan, 2017). This gives accessibility to all employees that need it while also granting new opportunities for growth.

[4] **Components -** A part or element of a larger whole (i.e., part of an enterprise system software)

[5] **Features -** A distinctive attribute or aspect of something (e.g., of a component)

	at the same time being able to track progress and record results. This gives accessibility to all employees that need it while also granting new opportunities for growth (Jehanzeb & Beshir, 2013).	**Feature 2: <u>Mentorships and apprenticeships</u>** This feature focuses on giving real on the job training that focuses directly onto the personalised development of employees of the organisation. The boosts the overall skills within the organisation and create a stronger team (Chatzimouratidis, Theotokas, & Lagoudis, 2011).
	Performance Management System: Is used to monitor and evaluate the employee's performance for the purpose of optimising it. This can be used to reward high performers and identify employees that have not met the standards. By continuously tracking it creates a feedback cycle that ensures employee contribution is effectively benefiting the organisation (Wood, 1999).	**Feature 1: <u>Goals Setting and tracking</u>** The allows the creation of clear metrics that can be used to track progress towards these goals. This ensures that employees are aligned with the business objectives. It also allows for the dynamic adjustment of goals with the shifting of priorities, while also provides data that can be used for other features of the HRMS (Latham, Borgany & Petitta, 2008).
		Feature 2: <u>Feedback and appraisals</u> This feature is used to facilitate feedback between employees and managers on current projects, team issues and other topics of necessary discussion. This will ultimately result in periodic appraisals based on performance and meeting goals (Selden & Sowa, 2011). This ensures that employees can always receive guidance and support if necessary.
Identification and explanation of typical challenges for a client organisation when integrating Human Resources Management enterprise system software into a client's business and technical environment	**CHALLENGES**	
	User Adoption: The HMR system need to conquer complexities of user's adoption problem. The organisations would innovate the new strategies to overcome the barrier that behind the acceptance and effective use of new HR tools, technologies, or policies among employees and HR professionals (Wolfe, 1995). These obstacles such as resistance to change, lack of training, and insufficient system integration, and developing solutions that enhance user engagement, streamline onboarding processes, and leading a positive user experience. Thus, the successful outcome will make organisations getting higher efficiency and ensuring the HR innovation are effectively working to support the workforce management and development (Chams & García-Blandón, 2019).	
	Integration with existing systems: Implementing new HRM systems, ensuring compatibility and seamless integration with current systems is complex (Chang-Howe, W., 2019).	

	Seamless integration requires developing customer interfaces or middleware, which can be complex and costly. In addition, compatibility issues between systems may have some issues and troubleshooting. The functional activities in HRM practices fit with the current system internally, externally and strategically. The importance of HRM practices in supporting the performance of primary activities (Malik, Pereira & Budhwar, 2018).
	Change Management: Change management represents a particular challenge for personnel management. Implementing a new HRM system requires plenty of training to ensure employees understand how to use it effectively. Insufficient training can lead to errors in new system. Organizations need to recognize the importance of training, it is frequently underemphasized during the change management process (Sung, W., & Kim, C., 2021). Effective change management practices to tackle issues like employee resistance, which can significantly hinder the adoption of new HRM systems (Boikhutso, T. M., 2013).

2.3. Examples of Human resource management enterprise system software and how they suit different types of organizations

The table below shows two examples of different Human Resource management enterprise system software. The table showcases how our consulting company breakdowns a system software into its attributes and analyses them to find the best suited software for a client's organisation.

CLIENT ORGANISATION CIRCUMSTANCES[6] FOR WHICH YOUR EXAMPLES WOULD BE SUITED	**EXAMPLE ENTERPRISE SYSTEM SOFTWARE 1**		**EXAMPLE ENTERPRISE SYSTEM SOFTWARE 2**	
	NAME:	*Rippling*	**NAME:**	*Arcoro*
	VENDOR:	*Rippling Inc.*	**VENDOR:**	*Arcoro*
1. What type of business operation would it be suited to? a. service b. merchandising c. manufacturing	Service		Service & Manufacturing	
2. Which industry sectors? (e.g., public service, health, select from the UN ILO categories[7])	Commerce Financial Engineering		Construction Landscaping Utilities	
3. What scale? - e.g., no. of customers, no of employees etc.	The scale of this software is relatively small scale around 2 – 2000. This is due to its compilation of services into a		The scale for this software is suited to large scale organisations with staff over 10000 (eLearning Industry, 2024).	

[6] **Circumstances -** Events and conditions associated with a client organisation

[7] Industries and sectors

	single system (Rippling, 2024).	
4. Which delivery mode? (clicks/bricks[8] or both)	Clicks	Clicks
5. Geographic coverage local or global?	Global coverage, Rippling is directly design specifically to help manage global teams (Rippling, 2024).	Local Coverage, it is designed to work most effectively with construction and heavy turnover companies (Arcoro, Inc., 2024).
6. What types and range of products and services would it be particularly suited to? e.g. mass-market retail (supermarket) vs specialist retail (clothing); B2B[9] vs B2C[10].	Rippling is an all-in-one human resource online management platform designed to serve businesses of any size, thanks to its highly scalable, cloud-based infrastructure. The platform covers all essential HR functions such as payroll, onboarding, and performance management (Rippling, 2024). While also integrating IT and finance operations. Rippling's versatility makes it particularly well-suited for industries like service, B2B, and B2C, where streamlined HR processes are essential for managing diverse and global workforces.	Arcoro is modular cloud-based HR management platform that is designed to be suited for industries that have high compliance demands such as construction and manufacturing industries (eLearning Industry, 2024). This can be for both Business to business and business to company organizations. The modularity of the HRMS software allows for customization to make the onboarding and train processes as efficient as possible while also having a built-in time and attendance system (Arcoro, Inc., 2024).

3. Consultant's corner's consulting processes for identifying a client organisation's needs, evaluating & selecting, and integrating[11] Human Resources Management enterprise system software

3.1. Identifying a client organisation's needs

IMPORTANT STEPS IN THE IDENTIFYING CLIENT NEEDS	INFORMATION COLLATED FROM RELIABLE SOURCES
Step 1 **Client and Stakeholder Interviews**	This is the first step to understand and identify the client's needs. This stage will involve organising and having a meeting with the client and related stakeholders. It is vital that a comprehensive meeting with takes place to gain as much necessary information for the other stages. The goals and objectives, identifying what specifically the client hopes to achieve with the implementation of HRM system. This will include both short- and long-term targets that they want the HR system to support (& Eklund, 2002). To address the clients' objectives a clear understanding of what the HRM systems need to be able to fulfil such as an improved

[8] **Delivery mode** - 'clicks' = online, 'bricks' = face- to- face/in person

[9] **B2B -** business to business

[10] **B2C** - business to consumer

[11] **Integrate -** to combine separate parts into a single whole

	payroll or onboarding system. These together are essential to the project's overall success and will aid in selecting an appropriate software choice. Clarifying what the clients' expectations are both in terms of the HRM system and as client of the consulting company. This can include implementation dates, frequency of meetings and support expectations of the consultancy company. Also, the expectations of the HRMS are important understand as this can ensure the decided solutions meet the client vision. Since this is the initial way information can be gained from the client this stage will be used to provide context to all other stages that follow this. This stage not only will align the approach with the client but will establish a foundation for an effective partnership throughout the project (Hea, 2015).
Step 2 **Understanding the client's current HR Processes**	The second step is to understand client's current HR processes. This means carefully reviewing and analysing how HR process in client's company is being carried out. This includes a review into what activities are involved and how the HR department interacts with other areas of the organisation (Nishii, Lepak, & Schneider, 2008). By performing a detailed overview into all the organisation's current HR procedures: including hiring, onboarding, performance reviews, management, payroll, and training and development (Becker & Huselid, 2006). Understanding these procedures in detail makes it easier to identify areas that would benefit from changes and improvements. This also applies to training and development processes; these are to be examined in depth to determine the shortcomings that a new program should solve. Examine the numerous connections between HR procedures and those of other divisions. Examine, for example how payroll and finance interact or how IT and onboarding work together to provide new recruits with access and equipment. Knowing these links guarantees that the new HRM software works seamlessly with other systems and improves departmental collaboration.
Step 3 **Analyse problems with the current HR processes**	The third step in determining a client organization's requirement for HRM system is to examine issues with the existing HR procedures. This entails assessing the problems and difficulties with the current HR process and comprehending how they affect the company (Jackson, Schuler, & Jiang, 2014). Analyse how HR processes affect Finance, IT, Operations, and Legal. Look for issues like poor data integration, miscommunication, or delays. For instance, if manual data entry errors between HR and Finance delay payroll, the new HRM system should address this. Identifying these problems ensures the new system improves departmental cohesion and efficiency (Ulrich & Dulebohn, 2015). Gather and examine the concerns that clients raise about their existing HR procedures, including inefficiencies, inaccurate system information, challenges gaining access to data, and unsatisfied users. For example, when the clients have problem managing and reporting employee data, addressing this trouble for the new HRM system would become

	important. Prioritizing essential features and enhancements for the new system is made easier by keeping track of these issues.
Step 4 **Understanding budget constraints**	The fourth step is to understand the budget of the client. This means calculating the estimated cost of the new HRM system software. In HRM system, understanding client's budget constraint, includes the budget for human resources, the cost of hiring, and the number of resources allocated to a role (He, Chaudhary & Jarvis, 2014). Start by knowing details about the client's budget for new HRM system software, including the total amount for purchase, implementation, and maintenance. In this way, we help them to identify workable solutions and avoids selections beyond their budgets. Then, we talk about the possible budget adjustments if needed. Suggesting options based on their financial limits. In addition, discussing cost-saving measures such as using existing infrastructure or choosing cloud-based solutions to minimize the costs. Budget planning and control are the fundamental of cost management. It emphasizes that using the budgeting method to quantitatively link planning and control (Aleks et al., 2018).
Step 5 **Requirements Analysis**	The final step is to analysis client's requirement. This stage will identify client organisation's needs by providing a structured approach to understand current challenges and future objectives. Estimating the scale of whole HRM system by establishing a clear boundary. In this way, we can avoid scope creep during the implementation. Scope creep means the gradual expansion or project's scope changes beyond its original objectives. In addition, we need to decide the delivery mode of the HRM system, such as click, brick or both. The click delivery mode means services can be access through the website or application. The brick delivery mode means services provided by physical location, such as offices, departments. HRM system includes services for managing human resources, including payroll, recruiting, benefits administration, and human resources development (Al-Sayed, Hassan & Omara, 2020). We need to ensure that all areas of HRM system (e.g., employee management, payroll, benefit, and training) are covered. Missing key features can result the system's effectiveness. Aligns the HRM system with organisation's goals, such as cost reduction, and productivity enhancement. HRM system strategies align with organizational goals and objectives, emphasizing the importance of vertical structural alignment and internal consensus. External fit and internal consensus are critical for HRM to contribute to organizational goals (Way & Johnson, 2005). The result can let HR functions achieve the organisation's outcomes, ensuring the system supports strategic plans.

3.2. Evaluating & selecting a suitable enterprise system software

IMPORTANT STEPS IN THE PROCESS OF EVALUATING & SELECTING SUITABLE ENTERPRISE SYSTEM SOFTWARE IN YOUR CATEGORY, FOR A CLIENT ORGANISATION	INFORMATION COLLATED FROM RELIABLE SOURCES
Step 1 **Finalising the criteria**	Before evaluating and choosing the right enterprise system software, finalizing the organisation's criteria is the first important step. This step will focus on requirement of comprehensive understanding of the organization's business needs, including current pain points and long-term goals (Hujainah& Baker, 2019). Collecting the different sections user's requirement can ensure that the chosen software achieve the expiation of organisation. Key criteria often include scalability to ensure the system would grow with the business, and flexibility in customization and integration with other tools (Bjarnason & Åberg etc., 2019). Moreover, using easily is a vital point to make sure that all employees can adopt effectively and use the system, reducing the need of extensive training and the resistance of changing (Hujainah& Baker, 2019). To have a good foundation of criteria, the organisations can make more informed, objective decisions when selecting software.
Step 2 **Comparing the different enterprise system software**	The second step is comparing the different HRMS software. Listing all key features and scalability in the future. Moreover, this enterprise system software must fit with the requirement of client. Using literature review or browsing online resources to find a suitable enterprise system. The literature review examines the research when selecting the HRM system software. It will focus on the support provided by software packages (Esangbedo et al., 2021). Collecting all proper HRMS software. Then, comparing features and scalability between them. Moreover, we need to find out how this HRMS software best fits with the needs of the client. For instance, the current HR data needed to process, then store into the new HRM system. The processing of raw files involves multiple algorithms. Therefore, choosing the algorithm usually decided by the data (Bell & Blais, 2019).
Step 3 **Vendor analysis**	The next stage is a crucial assessment of the vendors background and previous experiences with clients. This focus onto the software vendor ensures that they are capable and reliable before making the choice to work with them. This process begins with an analyse of the vendors history and reputation in the industry. Both client testimonials and industry reviews will be used to help streamline this process (Weng, Chen, & Li, 2019). Another important aspect to check is how long the vendor has been in the human resource management system software business and their success with previous clients' implementations (Weng, Chen, & Li, 2019). Further assessment needs to be done into the security measure that the vendor employs within its HRMS software to keep sensitive

	information secure and safe from leaks. The compliance with the necessary government guidelines and regulations will also be checked for further security (Khan et al., 2022). The final aspect that needs to be analysed it how well the vendor and its system software can support clients and its quality assurance and customization capabilities by checking previous the vendors policies on supporting clients in this way. This will have a major impact on how successful HRMS software will be in client's organisation.
Step 4 **Cost benefit Analysis**	The fourth step is do a detailed cost – benefit analysis that considered both the short- and long-term expenses. Compare the results with other HRMS to determine the most viable this links to previous steps. A detailed cost-benefit analysis is important in evaluating and choosing a suitable HRMS software for a client organization. This step requires assessing both shorth and long-term costs to ensure the chosen solution offers the best value that goes well with the client's budget and goals. **Short-Term costs:** • Evaluate the upfront costs of getting the HRMS, such as software licenses or subscription fees. • Consider the costs related with setting up and configuring the HRMS, which may involve hiring external consultants or internal IT staff time and adjusting the system to align the client's current workflows and data structures (Laumer, Maier & Eckhardt, 2014). • Include the cost of training of HR staff and all employees to use the new system efficiently. These costs could involve developing training materials or training sessions and hiring external trainers. **Long-Term costs:** • Evaluate continuing expenses such as maintenance fees for software updates or bug fixes regular patches to make sure that the HRMS stays secure and up to date with industry standards. These fees typically fall between 15 to 25% of the annual license or subscription cost (Bailey & Pearson, 2019). • Consider for extra operational costs, for instance, increased IT staff tasks to manage the HRMS or costs related to integrating the new system with existing applications. • Consider the potential costs associated with scaling the HRMS as the organization expands, such as extra licensee fees for more users, important customization to meet HR needs, and third-party integrations.

Step 5 **Choosing the right enterprise system software**	The final step is choosing the right HRMS software. Selecting the one that satisfy client's requirement. Also, not exceed the budget. When choosing the appropriate for a HRMS software, it's important to consider the specific needs and functionalities required for HRM support (Esangbedo et al., 2021b. The specific needs and processes of the organisation must be considered by the HRMS software. Ensuring that it assists with the key business functions. Evaluate whether the software can be easily modified to align with existing HR processes without costly development. Properly implemented HRM software helps organisation save time and money which emphasizes how crucial it is to select the right HRM system software for organizational goal alignment (Dike-Ndulue & Petrova, 2023).

3.3. Important steps for integrating/deploying the selected Human resource management enterprise system software into a client organisation

IMPORTANT STEPS FOR INTEGRATING THE ENTERPRISE SYSTEM INTO THE BUSINESS & IT ENVIRONMENT OF A CLIENT ORGANISATION	INFORMATION COLLATED FROM RELIABLE SOURCES
Step 1 **Drafting an implementation plan**	The first step is drafting an implementation, which has several important steps to integrate enterprise systems to the client organization's business and IT environment. Analysing of the current infrastructure is the first step to identify integration points and potential challenges (Ozkan & Yıldırım, 2016). Next, having a good constructure of clear goals, timelines, and responsibilities for each process of the implementation, which includes data migration, system customisation, and user training (Ozkan & Yıldırım, 2016). The organisation would focus on ensuring the seamless integration with existing systems, decreasing downtime, and preserving data integrity throughout the whole process. Moreover, the approach which is planned to resolve issues promptly and ensure a smooth transition for all users' needs. Including continued support, testing and feedback (Babu et al., 2019).
Step 2 **Data Integration**	Data integration is a vital step to integrate the enterprise systems into the client organisation's businesses and IT environment successfully. It includes incorporating data from different sources and ensuring seamless communication between new enterprise systems and existing databases or applications (Haas et al., 2002). Conducting a realised review of the current data structure is the first step to recognizing inconsistencies, redundancies, and gaps. Developing a data transferring strategy, including mapping data fields between the old

	and new systems, ensuring data accuracy, and maintaining data integrity during transfer (Kang& Hong, 2015). It is important to find an immediate data synchronisation protocol to prevent delays or errors in reporting and decision-making (Haas et al., 2002). Data security and compliance should be prioritised to protect the sensitive information in the process.
Step 3 **Employee Training**	This stage of the integration process is essential to the success of the HRMS system being properly utilised in the client organisation. This will begin before the complete integration of the system software into the client's organisation. This is to ensure that the employees and users are properly trained to operate the newly integrated systems when they are deployed (Nah et al., 2001). The purpose of this is to make the transition as swift as possible to avoid any disruptions to any of the daily operations. This process will begin with an assessment of the needs of each functional group within the client's organisation. This would include areas such as management, HR and each of the different technical area. This is to tailors the training to be specific for the systems each group will be utilising (Coulson et al., 2010). Training will ideally take place with both in person tutorial and online demonstrations that can be accessed at any time even after deployment as a help system (Coulson et al., 2010). This training stage will help to gain user feedback which can help to identify areas of weakness, so that more support can be given to facilitate a more effective integration.
Step 4 **Testing and optimising the HRMS software**	This stage will involve various groups within the client organisation as well as the consultancy company using the HRMS software in its various uses and applications across the organisation outlined by the goal and objectives of the client. During this phase the HRMS software is tested thoroughly across the different applications and uses that have been previously specified (Arachchi, Chong, & Kathabi, 2017). This is to ensure that the system operate correctly as in line with why they have been chosen. The testing can include but is not limited to testing of the different level in the system such as unit, integration and system testing (Fazzolino et al., 2018). The testing will determine if the system is meeting the organisations objectives and in the case that it is not changes and fine- tuning will take place. The fine-tuning of the HMRS software will be used to address any issues with the implementation and efficiency of the systems as well as presenting a final opportunity to customise aspects of the enterprise

	system software to be more in line with the requirements of the client. This approach ensures that the system is well tested and precisely optimised before full scale deployment into the organisation.
Step 5 **Deploying enterprise system software into the organisation**	The final step is deploying HRMS software into the live environment. Then, monitoring the outcome and the integration with other departments. We can apply ADKAR model to ensure employees adapt the new system. For example: • Awareness: Communicating the need for the HRM system and how it will benefit the whole organization. • Desire: Demonstrating the new system to employees to show how the system can make day-to-day work easier. • Knowledge: Providing detailed training and manual to make sure employees understand how to use the system effectively. • Ability: Ensuring that the system is successfully adopted and used by the employee. • Reinforcement: Monitoring how the system is being used and provide continuous support to reinforce proper usage and further integration. In addition, the integration of IT solutions with HRM systems can facilitate the automation of personnel management and document management processes (Khizbullina et al., 2024). The automation of various HRM procedures is possible by the development of information and communication technologies. In this way, it can improve HR effectiveness, lower costs, and streamline HR planning (Kent et al., 2023).

4. EY - Ernst & Young

4.1. Background information: EY - Ernst & Young

EY – Ernst & Young BACKGROUND FACTOR	EXPLANATION
1. Specialisation(s)	EY provides multinational professional services, including (Wikipedia contributors, 2024): • Counsulting: comprises three sub-service lines – Business Consulting, Technology Consulting, and People Advisory Services • People Advisory Services: HR, immigration, workforce mobility programs
2. Services provided for Human Resource Management System	HR Transformation which means HR teams must transform the old HR system to the new HRM system (*EY – Global*, n.d.). • Align your operating model with your service vision EY rapid HR/payroll assessment methodology will collect various insights about client's current operations. Then, they will not only build a new people operating model, but also build the value case for transforming the function and establish the proper plans. • Tackle the hard stuff before it impacts your schedule and costs EY HR/payroll innovation lab will build Minimal Viable Products (MVPs) for new HRM system. By going through iterative innovation, quality and experience feedback loops, client's MVPs will be improved and scaled for global deployment. • Design your services with your people, and tie them to desired business outcomes EY HR/payroll technology transformation suite will complete client's architecture by tackling the gaps and connecting the five layers seamlessly, including service, automation, cloud, data & analytics, and enablement.
3. Scale (e.g., market capitalisation, no. of customers, no of employees)	Ernst & Young is one of the world's largest professional service firms. It has a well-known global presence that is uses to leverage for its insights and services. EY has 395442 employees as of 2024 (Wikipedia contributors, 2024) with over 700 offices in 150 countries (EY – Global, n.d). Operating in 22 regions grouped by three geographical sectors including the Americas, Europe, Asia and Africa together and the final sector in Asia pacific (EY – Global, n.d).
4. Geographic coverage local or global?	Global

5. Types of services offered	Strategy by EY-Parthenon, Consulting People and workforce, Transactions and corporate finance, Assurance, Tax, Law, Technology, Managed Services, EY Private, EY Sustainability (*EY – Global*, n.d.).
6. Types of client organisations	EY has covered various area, including Consulting, Assurance, Tax, Law, Technology (*EY – Global*, n.d.).
7. Technical environment (this is given, do not change it)	*Legacy software[12] running on local IBM z/OS servers for the core business, productivity software (email, office software) delivered by cloud-based SaaS[13], and various other purchased or locally developed software apps that run on cloud-based PaaS[14] and are mostly Oracle + Linux based*
8. Financial performance (e.g., Revenue, Net income, Total assets, Total liability)	The financial performance of EY in 2023 was highly successful with revenue growth of over 14%. This led to further investments of $3.6 billion into audit quality, innovation and technology. With a further investment of $1.4 billion into AI and the development of a unifying platform. The total revenue for 2023 was $49.4 billion (Consulting.us, 2023). The total revenue can be broken down into individual markets that EY operates in. With the Americas contributes to 23.6 billion and EMEIA contributing 18.3 billion and Asia-pacific contributes 7.5 billion (Consultancy.com.au, 2023). The other financial performance indicators for EY global are not disclosed publicly with some country specific measures being published in their respective annual reports.
9. Organisational Culture & Work Environment	The organisational culture is great where people want to help you and see you grow and committed in your growth opportunities.However, there are some severe problems about bullying, long hours, and a toxic work environment (Tadros, 2023). EY demonstrates a high level of professionalism and in-depth expertise in business consulting, enabling them to tackle complex client challenges. Their dedication and innovative approach make EY a reliable partner for achieving sustainable growth and success in any situation (*Reviews EY Employee Ratings and Reviews | SEEK*, n.d.).
10. Strengths/Successes	EY is a global leader in assurance, tax, transaction and advisory services (Shastri, 2022) The insights and quality services we deliver help build trust and confidence in the capital markets and in economies the world over. EY's strong focus on diversity, equity, and inclusiveness (DEI) drives both business success and employee satisfaction. Through initiatives like its Neurodiversity Centers of

[12] **Legacy Software-** software that is old and is tied to a particular version of an operating system or hardware model but still fulfills a business need.

[13] **SaaS -** Software as a Service

[14] **PaaS -** Platform as a Service

	Excellence, EY supports neurodiverse employees, resulting in higher retention rates and increased productivity. The firm's data-driven approach to DEI, combined with its global reach and commitment to gender balance, has led to innovative solutions for clients and over $1 billion in value creation. EY's inclusive culture not only attracts top talent but also helps build diverse teams that improve problem-solving and foster long-term business growth (Carroll, 2024).
11. Weaknesses / Problems / Failures (e.g., active legal issues)	Ernst & Young is laying off dozens of partners across all U.S. businesses, a deeper round of partner cuts than usual as the Big Four accounting firm faces slowing demand for certain services and seeks to cut costs following its failed plan to break up the firm (Maurer & Saeedy, 2023). In June 2022, the SEC fined the firm US$100 million "for cheating by its audit professionals on exams required to obtain and maintain Certified Public Accountant(CPA) licenses, and for withholding evidence of this misconduct from the SEC's Enforcement Division during the Division's investigation of the matter" ("Ernst & Young to Pay $100 Million Penalty for Employees Cheating on CPA Ethics Exams and Misleading Investigation," 2022).

4.2. Value of your expertise and tools to EY – Ernst & Young

The table below presents a detailed overview of the specific areas of expertise and tools used by Consultants Corner in the consultancy in regards to Human Resource management systems. These are highlighted for the purpose of outlining these key aspects to help provide Ernst & Young (EY) a clear justification as to the value that Consultants Corner can bring upon being acquired.

DESCRIPTION OF EXPERTISE AND TOOLS	VALUE TO LARGE CONSULTING COMPANY	JUSTIFICATION i.e., how it creates that value
1. Expertise: Specialised knowledge of the successful integration of HRMS	The specialised knowledge and expertise of Consultant Corner in the area of Human resource management systems evaluation, selection and integration in a successful manner. This can help EY handle complex HRMS Intergrations and streamline the involved processes (Whicker & Andrews, 2004). By having access to such specialistic knowledge EY can also reduce its time and cost associated with improving client's satisfaction (Yahiaoui, Chebbi, & Weber, 2016).	The added expertise in the integration of HRMS bring significant value for EY by enhancing its ability to deliver tailored and client specific HR management solutions that can meet the various needs of the clients. This is critical for gaining more clients due to a good reputation and ability to give a more valuable service to clients. The successful integrations of HRMS are crucial for ensuring that a smooth transition of operations takes place. This leads to increased employee engagement and operational cost reductions (Stone & Deadrick, 2015). The ability to customise HR solutions based on clients' specifications will allow EY to off more precise and scalable

		solutions, leading to higher client satisfaction (Way & Johnson, 2005).
2. Expertise: HR transformation	The HR role is fast changing from its traditional role in recruitment, payroll, and compliance to wider issues of staff health and safety, along with the provision of great people experiences (Azam, 2023). With the evolution happening at workplaces, HR teams need to move away from just administrative services to a more strategic, future-looking people service that fosters well-being, engagement, and productivity. Embracing emerging technologies and bold new ways of working, human resources will be integral in driving the future of work-forward in developing a more resilient, connected workforce-and ensuring business outcomes that are sustainable long-term (Singh, 2017).	With the help of their HR transformation service, EY focuses on shifting companies from conventional HR systems to an employee-centric, technology enabled paradigm which revolves around superior employee experience, health and safety. They use HR technology more or less SAP SuccessFactors, Oracle HCM, Workday, for the purpose of advancing the automation and the decision-making. Retraining along with agile workforce planning are future-organisational factors as well as diversity that EY mentions augmented (Esangbedo et al., 2021). Their strategies comprise culture shift, management of change along with compliance which hopes that the functions of HR will be able to tackle the current issues within the workplace and improving employee engagement and wellbeing (Laumer, Maier & Eckhardt, 2014).
3. Tools: Specialized advisory tools and data-driven solutions to build a HRMS	These tools can enhance the efficiency of consulting process, and provide a suitable solution to the clients (Chen & Wang, 2021). In this way, HRMS can solve the current issues in client's company. First, specialized advisory tools can improve service delivery by providing specialized insights and data-driven solutions provide technological solutions tailor to EY's clients (Patel & Gupta, 2023). Second, they expand EY's client offerings, helping the firm to differentiate itself in a highly competitive landscape.	These tools strengthen EY's consulting infrastructure, particularly in digital transformation, data analytics, and stakeholder management. By integrating these tools and resources, EY can offer more personalized and efficient solutions to clients, which improves client satisfaction and long-term loyalty. Fo instance, payroll software integrated with the HRMS tool to facilitate seamless integration between the current applications (*A Strategic Decision Analysis Framework for Software-as-a-Service Selection : A Systematic Data-Driven Approach - University of Twente Student Theses*, n.d.). Web-based technology makes it possible for managers and employees to make decisions anywhere in the world with access to HR data. This minimizes the need for in-person visits to the HR department and ensures the correctness of data in real-time (Pea-Assounga & Sibassaha, 2024).

5. Integrating/Deploying Consultant's Corner with EY – Ernst & Young

5.1. Organisational integration

The table below contains the important organisational factors that need to be considered when Consultant Corner is integrated with EY after acquisition. These factors are crucial for ensuring that there is a smooth transition and a successful integration. These factors are identified for the purpose of minimising disruptions and allowing integration to happen cohesively.

ORGANISATIONAL FACTORS	JUSTIFICATION
Adaptability in HR Transformation: Adaptability also forms one of the key reasons that need consideration in EY's HR transformation (Zhang et al., 2021). As HR evolves from old-world services and moves more into employee well-being and experience, processes have to be accommodating, continuous in improvement, and seamless for the HR team to engage with evolving workforce requirements (Galanti et al, 2023).	Adaptability is key because workforce expectations are shifting really fast, and everything is centered on the well-being, safety, and experiences of employees (Pulakos et al., 2000). In that direction, talent attraction, retention, and connection cannot be engendered through traditional HR services. EY needs to be adapted to processes, technology, and culture in order to be competitive, help employee satisfaction, and create long-term organizational success. This adaptability will grant more power to HR teams in real-time challenges, innovation, and workforce engagement in an ever-changing environment (Pulakos et al., 2006).
Knowledge transfer and retention: Retaining and effectively transferring the specialised HRMS knowledge and capabilities of Consultant Corner to EY is vital to the success of the acquisition (Castro-Casal, Neira-Fontela, & Álvarez-Pérez, 2013). Ey needs to fully capture the expertise, tools and practices that Consultant Corner uses in order to maximise organisational value Lin, Chang, & Tsai, 2016).	The expertise must be fully integrated and shared by properly incorporating it into EY's processes this is to ensure that the value of the acquisition meets the desired expectations for both parties. This will involve developing strategies specifically for knowledge transfer and collaboration between teams. A failure to do so effectively will lead to reduced operational efficiency and ultimately fail to reach the value of the acquisition. (Vaara, 2002) The transfer is also important for retaining and maintaining the trust of existing clients from both parties, any disruptions or degradation of services during the transition period may lead to lower client satisfaction. By implementing the effective transfer strategies such as cross – company training and knowledge repositories. Ey can effectively

	integrate Consultant Corners capabilities into itself. (Steynberg & Veldsman, 2011)

5.2. Technology integration

The table below contains the important technology factors which need to be considered as Consultant Corner is integrated with EY after acquisition. These factors are crucial for ensuring that there is a successful data transition and integration with existing system. These factors have been chosen in order to deduce disturbance and promote seamless integration.

TECHNOLOGY FACTOR	JUSTIFICATION
Technology Usability in HR Integration: A critical technology factor that EY needs to consider in the integration of innovative HR software is its usability (*Usability Evaluation of Human Resource Management Information System (HRMIS)*, 2014). These tools need to be easy to use for HR teams and employees to ensure ease in adoption with minimum disturbance. Intuitive interfaces are a must for seamless integration with other systems, increasing productivity to competently support the change in HR (*The Usability Analysis of Human Resource Information System (HRIS) Using Usability Scale System and Concurrent Think Aloud*, 2022).	Usability is a critical factor because easy-to-use HR software encourages employee adoption and enhances employee productivity and satisfaction (Becker& Huselid, 2006). If the tools are too complex or difficult to navigate, employees will resist using the systems, which may result in a waste of resources and negatively affect the effort of HR transformation (Butler& Callahan, 2014). EY could have controlled this factor by involving end-users in the selection process, testing usability, and providing comprehensive training and support. This will ensure that the tool serves the needs of the organization and creates a good user experience, hence successful integration.
Cloud Integration and Security: EY's environment includes cloud-based SaaS and PaaS platforms. In addition to meeting strict security and data protection standards, innovative solutions need to be compatible with these cloud solutions. This includes data encryption, secure authentication, and compliance with industry standards like GDPR (Darwish, 2018;Alosaimi & Alnuem, 2016).	Cloud solutions are predicted to become the major method of hosting company HR Information Systems in the future, providing customized solutions and higher performance for HR department needs (Zapotocny M, 2015). In the cloud solutions, the cloud integration is important to enable scalability, flexibility, and enhanced collaboration across Consultant's Corner and EY's teams. That's because, both firms handle customer's sensitive data, security is a primary concern. Effective management might involve a security assessment of the innovative solutions, ensuring they have secure cloud integrations, and alignment with EY's cloud security policies and compliance requirements. For instance, SaaS cloud computing enhances HRMS efficiency and information trust improves HR information security during transmission (*Research on Cloud Computing Architecture and Optimization of Human Resource Management System*, 2024).

6. Conclusion

This acquisition report outlines the strategic value and processes that Consultant Corner utilises in its specialised area of enterprise systems software consultancy, specifically in human resources management systems. The purpose of this report is to present a clear case to EY, identifying and showcasing the numerous processes and systems that Consultant Corner employs that can enhance EY's Human resource management system consultancy services through acquisition. The specialist HRMS knowledge that Consultant Corner has garnered is shown in report section 2.1 and 2.2 where the enterprise system software is broken down into its functional areas and characteristics. While in 2.3 its practical application for clients in terms of real HRMS technologies are explored and analysed to determine the merits of them. This is linked to industry leading HRMS technologies that operate in different business sectors and compared based on functionality. The analysis of technologies links to the crucial section 3.1 where Consultant Corners client processes for identification of client needs. Section 3.2 showcases the processes that are involved in evaluation of HRMS solutions and section 3.3 is involved with integration of the decided HRMS solutions for the clients. The section 4.1 explores the details and capabilities of EY and how Consultant Corner can bring value through acquisition in section 4.2. The identifications of areas and processes that need to be considered during the acquisition to ensure a smooth technological and organisational integration in section 5.1 and 5.2. In conclusion, this report demonstrates how the acquisition of Consultant Corner will provide EY with enhanced specialist HRMS capabilities that can meet clients' needs more effectively, strengthening EY's position as an industry leader in HRMS.

7. Reference List

REFERENCE TO YOUR SOURCE (APA 7th)	SOURCE TYPE	RELIABILITY OF SOURCE
A Strategic Decision Analysis Framework for Software-as-a-Service Selection : A Systematic Data-Driven Approach - University of Twente Student Theses. (n.d.). http://essay.utwente.nl/98591/	Journal Article	
Al-Sayed, M. M., Hassan, H. A., & Omara, F. A. (2020). CloudFNF: An ontology structure for functional and non-functional features of cloud services. Journal of Parallel and Distributed Computing, 141, 143–173. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpdc.2020.03.019	Journal Article	
Aleks, O., Nikitina, R., Litovskaya, Y. V., & Ponomareva, O. S. (2018b). Development of the cost management Mechanism for metal products manufacturing based on budgeting method. Academy of Strategic Management Journal/Academy of Strategic Management Journal, 17(5), 1. https://www.abacademies.org/articles/D	Journal Article	

evelopment-of-the-cost-management-mechanism-for-metal-products- 1939-6104-17-5-268.pdf		
Alosaimi, R., & Alnuem, M. (2016). A Survey on Security Risk Management Frameworks in Cloud Computing. *Sixth International Conference on Advances in Computing and Information Technology*, 01-11. https://doi.org/10.5121/csit.2016.60901	Journal Article	
Arachchi, S. M., Chong, S. C., & Kathabi, A. (2017). System testing evaluation for enterprise resource planning to reduce failure rate. *Advances in Science Technology and Engineering Systems Journal*, *2*(1), 6–15. https://doi.org/10.25046/aj020102	Journal Article	
Arcoro, Inc. (2024). *Get started with Arcoro* Arcoro. https://go.arcoro.com/get-started-with-arcoro-today	Company Website*	This company website source is directly by the company in which the example of the HRMS software is being produced by. The information of this website falls in line with the CRAAP test. The information is up to date and current, directly relevant as it is about the exact example of software in discussion. The information comes from the producers of the software. The reliability of the information is reliable due to it coming directly from the source and discusses factual element of the software such as capabilities and features. The purpose of the website is to inform and market the software to clients.
Azam, M. S. (2023). How can we build human resources (HR) that deliver value? A systematic literature review of traditional and transformational HR roles. *Global business and organizational excellence*, *42*(4), 81-92. First published: 04 January 2023 https://doi.org/10.1002/joe.22191	Journal Article	
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Bailey, J. E., & Pearson, S. W. (2019). Developing a tool for measuring and analyzing computer user satisfaction. Management Science, 29(5), 530-545. https://doi.org/10.1287/mnsc.29.5.530	Journal Article	
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Bell, M., & Blais, J. M. (2019). "-Omics" workflow for paleolimnological and geological archives: A review. The Science of the Total Environment, 672, 438–455. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2019.03.477	Journal Article	
Bjarnason, E., Åberg, P., & Ali, N. B. (2023). Software selection in large-scale software engineering: A model and criteria based on interactive rapid reviews. *Empirical Software Engineering*, *28*(2). https://doi.org/10.1007/s10664-023-10288-w	Journal Article	
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Boikhutso, T. M. (2013). CHANGE MANAGEMENT: THE IMPACT ON SYSTEMS IMPLEMENTATION. a BUSINESS APPLICATION SOLUTION CENTRE (BASC) CASE STUDY (By University of South Africa & BASC; P. Goldstone, Ed.). https://uir.unisa.ac.za/bitstream/handle/10500/10196/dissertation_boikhutso_tm.pdf?sequence=1	Journal Article	
Butler, M. G., & Callahan, C. M. (2014). Human resource outsourcing: Market and operating performance effects of administrative HR functions. Journal of Business Research, 67(2), 218–224. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2012.09.026	Journal Article	
Carroll, L. (2024, July 1). How EY is focusing on neurodiverse talent – and why it benefits everyone. *BBC*. https://bbc.com/worklife/article/20240320-ey-karyn-twaronite-neurodiversity-bbc-executive-interview	News Website*	The article Carroll, L. (2024) on the BBC is very reliable; the BBC was an older and well-known media outlet for its accuracy of reporting, comprehensiveness, and maintenance of the standards within journalism. This particular article effectively delivers credible arguments relating to EY's focus on neurodiverse talent because it draws insight from a direct interview with EY executive Karyn Twaronite. It is more credible since primary sources, like executive interviews, were relied upon in the article; thus, it is a good source of information for EY's neurodiversity initiatives.
Castro-Casal, C., Neira-Fontela, E., & Álvarez-Pérez, M. D. (2013). Human resources retention and knowledge transfer in mergers and acquisitions. Journal of Management & Organization, 19(2), 188-209. https://doi.org/10.1017/jmo.2013.11	Journal Article	
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Consultancy.com.au. (2023, August 27). Strong second half drives record EY revenues for 2023. Retrieved from https://www.consultancy.com.au/news/7880/strong-second-half-drives-record-ey-revenues-for-2023	News Website*	The article was published on August 27, 2023, which makes it up-to-date. Since it talks about EY's revenue in 2023, the timing is appropriate and current. Moreover, the information is directly related to anyone interested in EY's financial performance for 2023. The source is from a website that focuses on news about the consulting industry. It's still a reliable source for consulting-related information

		because it specializes in that area. The article likely provides correct information because it covers EY's financial results, which can be confirmed by official reports from EY. It provides specific revenue figures, so it's likely based on solid data. Finally, the article is meant to inform readers about EY's revenue growth, not to sell anything or push a particular viewpoint. It's straightforward and factual, which makes it more trustworthy.
Consulting.us. (2023, September 18). EY reports nearly $50 billion in revenue in FY23. Retrieved from https://www.consulting.us/news/9681/ey-reports-nearly-50-billion-in-revenue-in-fy23	News Website*	This news article is current and up to date as it has the most recent annual financial performance report for EY as 2024 financial year is still not over as of writing this. The relevance of the source is directly relevant to the use, as it is used for the financial performance and assets breakdown of EY. This website gives this information and cites the relevant sources such as EY itself and other financial leaders such as Bloomberg. The information is provide by consulting.us as American consultancy news website focusing on constancy companies around the world and news related to them primarily for American audiences. The information is as accurate as possible as the true financial figures are not all disclosed only report from Ey themselves have been reported as well as comments from financial analysts. The purpose of the source fits its usage in this report as it has been used as to inform the readers of the financial performance of EY which is what its information has been used for.
Coulson, T., Olfman, L., Ryan, T., & Shayo, C. (2010). Enterprise Systems Training Strategies. *Journal of Organizational and End User Computing*, *22*(3), 22–39. https://doi.org/10.4018/joeuc.2010070102	Journal Article	

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eLearning Industry. (2024). Arcoro. eLearning Industry. Retrieved September 3, 2024 https://elearningindustry.com/directory/elearning-software/arcoro	Company Website*	This website is a respected reviewing site. It provided information taken directly from the producers' websites and articles to inform readers. It is also passes the CRAAP test. As it is frequent updated with user reviews and testimonials in addition to more well trusted updates to the reviewed pages. The information directly provides necessary background and application information about the system software example. The source of the information is taken from the producer itself therefore, it is well trusted. The purpose is to inform client which is in line with the purpose for accessing it for this report.
Ernst & Young to Pay $100 Million Penalty for Employees Cheating on CPA Ethics Exams and Misleading Investigation. (2022, November 4). *SEC*. https://www.sec.gov/newsroom/press-releases/2022-114	News Website*	The SEC press release about Ernst & Young paying a $100 million penalty is quite reliable source. Published in November 2022, so it's fairly recent still relevant for understanding the company's issues. The informations are about the penalties and problems EY encounted. In addition, it comes directly from the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC), which is the government agency

		that inspects financial regulations. Since it's an official announcement, the details are accurate and trustworthy. The purpose of the press release is to let the public know what happened, and without any bias or hidden agenda. Overall, it's a dependable source for understanding the situation at EY.
Esangbedo, M. O., Bai, S., Mirjalili, S., & Wang, Z. (2021). Evaluation of human resource information systems using grey ordinal pairwise comparison MCDM methods. Expert Systems With Applications, 182, 115151. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.eswa.2021.115151	Journal Article	
Esangbedo, M. O., Bai, S., Mirjalili, S., & Wang, Z. (2021b). Evaluation of human resource information systems using grey ordinal pairwise comparison MCDM methods. *Expert Systems With Applications*, *182*, 115151. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.eswa.2021.115151	Journal Article	
EY – Global. (n.d.). https://assets.ey.com/content/dam/ey-sites/ey-com/en_gl/topics/global-review/2023/ey-value-realized-2023-reporting-progress-on-global-impact-v3.pdf	Company Website*	This website is a sub domain of the the official website of Ernst and Young (EY). This is the financial records that were published at the end of 2023 as part of a global review report. This source of information meets the relevance requirement of its usage as it has been used as reference to finding and presenting the information of EY. The information is directly from EY and has a high reliable due to the availability of financial figures and citations regarding its own information on the website. The purpose of this webpage is to inform investor and financial experts on the performance of EY in 2023.
EY – Global. (n.d.). https://www.ey.com/en_au/services	Company Website*	This website is the official website of the Australian Ernst and Young (EY). This is regularly updated and up to date with current and past information regarding all of EY's

		activities, consultancy and investment practices. This source of information meets the relevance requirement of its usage as it has been used as reference to finding and presenting the information of EY. The information is directly from EY and has a high reliable due to the availability of financial figures and citations regarding its own information on the website. The purpose of the website and information is to inform readers and present information for clients as well as serving as a repository of past practices and information.
EY – Global. (n.d.). https://www.ey.com/en_gl	Company Website*	This website is the official website of Ernst and Young (EY). This is regularly updated and up to date with current and past information regarding all of EY's activities, consultancy and investment practices. This source of information meets the relevance requirement of its usage as it has been used as reference to finding and presenting the information of EY. The information is directly from EY and has a high reliable due to the availability of financial figures and citations regarding its own information on the website. The purpose of the website and information is to inform readers and present information for clients as well as serving as a repository of past practices and information.
EY – Global. (n.d.). https://www.ey.com/en_kr/locations#:~:text=With%20over%20700%20office%20locations,of%20the%20Executive%20and%20Regions	Company Website*	This website is a part of the official website of Korean Ernst and Young (EY). This is regularly updated and up to date with current and past information regarding all of EY's activities, consultancy and investment practices. This source of information meets the relevance requirement of its usage as it has been used as reference to finding and presenting the information of EY. The information is directly from EY and has a high reliable due to the availability of financial figures and citations

		regarding its own information on the website. The purpose of the website and information is to inform readers and present information for clients as well as serving as a repository of past practices and information.
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Kavanagh, M. J., Thite, M., & Johnson, R. D. (2015). Human Resource Information Systems: Basics, applications, and future directions | Online Resources. (n.d.). https://study.sagepub.com/kavanagh4e	Company Website*	This company website is companion site for the textbook "*Human Resource Information Systems* by Michael J. Kavanagh and Richard D. Johnson" This website provides further information into this topic and provides a more accessible way to view the contents through a topic select. The information is reliable as it passes the CRAAP test. The website is a companion to the textbook which was published in 2017 which mean it is current. The relevance is directly applicable as this refers to Human resource management practices that are used in this analysis. The source of the information are two professors and have published 3 earlier editions, justifying its reliability. Finally, the purpose of the information is to inform and teach readers about the areas of human resource management, the basics application and future of the industry.
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Malik, A., Pereira, V., & Budhwar, P. (2018). Value creation and capture through human resource management practices. Organizational Dynamics, 47(3), 180–188. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.orgdyn.2017.09.002	Journal Article	
Maurer, M., & Saeedy, A. (2023, December 12). EY Is Laying Off U.S. Partners Amid Tough Economic Conditions. *THE WALL STREET JOURNAL*. https://www.wsj.com/articles/ey-is-laying-off-u-s-partners-amid-tough-economic-conditions-9efc4aa6?reflink=desktopwebshare_permalink	News Website*	The article from The Wall Street Journal about EY laying off U.S. partners is a reliable source of information. It was published lately, in December 2023, making it up-to-date and relevant to the current economic state at EY. The Wall Street Journal is a well-known and reliable news source for

		business and finance, so we can trust that the information is accurate. The authors are probably experienced reporters, and the article aims to inform readers. They are not to advocate any particular viewpoint. Overall, this article is a decent and trustworthy source to use for understanding what's happening at EY.
Muktamar, A., & A, N. N. (2024). The integration of HR analytics and decision making. Deleted Journal, 1(1), 182–189. https://doi.org/10.62207/aj4nj061	Journal Article	
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Reviews EY employee ratings and reviews | SEEK. (n.d.). SEEK. https://www.seek.com.au/companies/ey-432331/reviews	News Website*	The ratings and reviews about EY on SEEK are neither here nor there in terms of employee ratings because they have their own limitations. Considering the fact that SEEK is one of the most consulted job portals in Australia, gaining insights into personal experiences from current and former employees will help in understanding general employee sentiments. While it gives a helpful

		snapshot on the fulfillment of employees with their work environment and culture in the company, the nature of such reviews may be different from one person to the other and may not give a comprehensive view of EY's work. Besides, such reviews are mainly based on personal factors and may not represent all EY's operations, therefore needing verification of these facts and complementing them with more structured or verified data from other sources.
Rippling. (2024). The #1 rated HR system in Australia. Retrieved September 3, 2024 https://www.rippling.com/en-AU/aus-hris-page	Company Website*	This company website source is directly by the company in which the example of the HRMS software is being produced by. The information of this website falls in line with the CRAAP test. The information is up to date and current, directly relevant as it is about the exact example of software in discussion. The information comes from the producers of the software. The reliability of the information is reliable due to it coming directly from the source and discusses factual element of the software such as capabilities and features. The purpose of the website is to inform and market the software to clients.
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Shastri, A. (2022). Exclusive SWOT Analysis Of EY - 2024. IIDE. Retrieved from https://iide.co/case-studies/swot-analysis-of-ey/	News Website*	The SWOT Analysis of EY by Aditya Shastri in IIDE discusses a more practical SWOT analysis of EY, supported by assignments and case studies in digital marketing done by the students of IIDE. This provides rich insight into the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats associated with EY; however, it was essentially designed as an educational document with a focus on digital marketing. While informative, it is a soft source and henn=ce perhaps of limited reliability strategic position, it would require cross-referencing with more formal business or financial sources.
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Sung, W., & Kim, C. (2021). A study on the Effect of change management on Organizational Innovation: focusing on the mediating effect of members' innovative behavior. Sustainability, 13(4), 2079. https://doi.org/10.3390/su13042079	Journal Article	
Tadros, E. (2023, July 27). EY Broderick report: What staff at the big four firm say about what it's really like to work there. *Australian Financial Review*. https://www.afr.com/companies/professional-services/in-their-own-words-what-staff-say-about-ey-20230726-p5drjd	News Website*	The article by Tadros, E. (2023) has been taken from the Australian Financial Review; hence, it is a valid source regarding the work culture at EY and a review of EY's employees since the AFR has established its credibility through in-depth business and financial reporting. It directly quoted EY staff, hence reflecting internal perspectives. However, like any report based on employee feedback, it may carry subjective views that reflect individual experiences, and so one should

		consider this within the broader context of using this data to draw conclusions.
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Wikipedia contributors. (2024) *Ernst & Young*. Wikipedia. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ernst_%26_Young#Services	Other Websites*	The Wikipedia article on Ernst & Young has up-to-date information, which is crucial because things in the world change quickly. It provides relevant information about EY, like its services and history, which can assist us get a general idea of the company. However, anyone can edit Wikipedia. Hence, the information may not always come from experts, and it's possible that recent modifications haven't been fully checked. Double-checking the sources that the article cites can ensure the information is accurate and reliable.
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8. Amendment History

VERSION NUMBER	DATE	APPROVED BY	AMENDMENTS
V.1.0	1 June 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Creation of initial template
V.1.1	8 June 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 1 instructions
V.1.2	15 June 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 2 instructions
V.1.3	22 June 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 3 instructions
V.1.4	29 June 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 4 instructions
V.1.5	5 July 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 5 instructions

V.1.6	12 July 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 6 instructions
V.1.7	26 July 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to overall formatting, structure, and typography
V.2.0	1 August 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Team Report template published on Canvas
V.2.1	15 August 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Updates to section 2.2 instructions
V.2.2	23 August 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Update to examples in column 1, row 2 of the table in section 2.3
V.2.3	28 August 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Minor changes to instructions and footnotes to achieve consistency and improve clarity in all sections.
V.3.0	12 September 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	1. Minor changes to instructions and footnotes to achieve consistency and improve clarity in all sections. 2. In Sections 3 and 3.2, the Process "investigate" has been removed, and "evaluation" and "selection" have been combined.
V.4.0	16 October 2022	Dr Andrea Stern	Major updates to instructions in sections 4, 5 and conclusion.
V.5.0	1 August 2023	Omar Acuache	Major updates to all sections.
V.6.0	28 February 2024	Omar Acuache	Major updates to general instructions and sections 1 to 7.
V.7.0	28 May 2024	Omar Acuache	Major updates to general instructions and sections 1 to 7.
V.7.1	2 August 2024	Omar Acuache	Minor updates to the document formatting.
V.8.0	12 September 2024		Update the section 1, 2, 3, 7, 8.
V.8.1	13 September 2024		Minor updates for removing red texts.
V.8.2	13 September 2024		Update the reference list
V.9.0	20 October 2024		Update the section 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
V.9.1	24 October 2024		Update the missing reference and final checking